Intraocular Lens Anatomy

Images used: 7.2, 7.7, 7.9, 7.12, 7.13, 7.14, 7.8

I. Terminology

A. Poles

B. Equator

II. Optical properties

A. Refractive power of the unaccommodated lens is approximately 20 D.

III. Anatomic divisions

A. Embryonic nucleus

B. Lens epithelium

1. Germinative zone

C. Lens fibers

1. Fetal nucleus and lens sutures

D. Lens capsule

E. Clinical correlate: cataracts

IV. Slit lamp appearance

A. Biconvex nature

B. Zones

1. Anterior lens capsule

2. Subcapsular clear zone

3. Remodeling zone

4. Cortex and nuclei

5. Anterior Y suture

6. Embryonic nucleus

7. Posterior inverted Y suture

8. Posterior cortex

9. Posterior capsule

V. Zonules

VI. Accommodation